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Palestinian student freed in Vt. loses this round

Judges say case belongs in immigration court

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

A federal appeals court on Tuesday ruled that Mohsen Mahdawi, a Palestinian student who led protests against the Israel-Hamas war at Columbia University, should not have been released from detention last year when the Trump administration sought to deport him.

A three-member panel of the Second Circuit Court of Appeals said a district court judge in Vermont, where Mahdawi was detained during a citizenship interview in April 2025, overstepped his authority when he ordered Mahdawi freed after 16 days in a Vermont prison.

The appellate judges said that Mahdawi's deportation case should have proceeded in immigration court, which is part of the executive branch, and that it was premature for a federal court to step in and consider the free-speech and other legal questions he had raised in his defense.

"In immigration matters, our Constitution is clear," the judges wrote: The power to regulate immigration belongs to Congress and the executive branch, not the courts.

The decision is a major setback not only for Mahdawi, a 35-year-old green card holder, but for other noncitizens who have sought relief from sympathetic district court judges when caught up in the Trump administration's immigration crackdown.

Mahdawi was one of a number of foreign-born student-activists targeted for their pro-

MAHDAWI, Page A6

BU agrees to pay a bigger share to city

By Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

Boston University will pay the City of Boston more than \$104 million in cash and other benefits over the next five years as part of a newly signed deal that Mayor Michelle Wu's office touted as the largest of its kind for a tax-exempt nonprofit in the city's history.

Boston officials on Tuesday framed the agreement as a significant win at a time when the city is struggling with surging costs and stalling revenue growth. Some advocates argued, though, that the university, backed by a multibillion-dollar endowment, could afford to give more.

Under the so-called payment in lieu of taxes, or PILOT, agreement, BU will make annual cash payments to the city, starting with \$6.7 million in payments covering fiscal year 2026, which ended last month, and up to \$8.3 million a year by fiscal year 2030.

BU will also increase the amount of "community benefits" it contributes to the city, such as scholarships for Boston Public Schools students and other services. It will pay \$12.7 million in the first year of the deal and up to \$14 million annually.

That will bring BU's total yearly contribution to the city to about \$22.3 million in fiscal year 2030, a 19 percent jump from the \$18.7

BOSTON UNIVERSITY, Page A10

Mass. poised to ease abortion rules

Doctors would be allowed to make call on late-term pregnancies

By Samantha J. Gross
and Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts Democratic leaders said they expect to pass a bill Wednesday that would dramatically loosen the state's already-liberal abortion laws by making it easier for women to terminate late-term pregnancies.

The vote comes in the final hours

of formal legislative sessions for the year and, if passed and signed into law, could make Massachusetts' abortion law among the country's broadest.

Currently, the state allows the termination of pregnancies up to 24 weeks' gestation. Beyond that, doctors are permitted to perform abortions under specific circumstances, including only if it's necessary to

preserve the life of a patient.

The legislation up for a vote Wednesday would instead leave the decision to end a pregnancy at 24 weeks or later up to "the professional judgement of a physician" alone.

Its emergence comes as other states, mostly Republican-led, have severely restricted abortion access in the wake of the Supreme Court's decision in 2022 to overturn Roe v.

Wade. Some more liberal states, including Massachusetts, have countered by bolstering existing laws that, for example, protect online and mail access to abortion amid fears of future restrictions.

State Representative Christine Barber, who sponsored the legislation, said it was prompted by the number of people who traveled outside Massachusetts to receive a later-term abortion.

ABORTION, Page A6

'It's kind of crazy. I'm just speechless.'

KEVIN PARK, who is now filling 100 orders a week



PHOTOS BY MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Home cooks get the word out and new customers eat it up

Facebook Marketplace and other social media give sellers' profiles a boost

By Karyna Cheung
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Not long ago, Kevin Park quit his corporate finance job and took a shot at his lifelong dream of cooking and selling his own home-made Korean food.

His first move: a post on Facebook Marketplace.

The 23-year-old doesn't have the means to establish a brick-and-mortar restaurant. He was looking to test the waters and treated the listing as a trial to see if his menu of home-cooked stews, rice dishes, and soy marinated eggs might gain traction, without taking too much risk. But soon, a Boston food social media creator found Park, and a few posts later, a trial run had turned into an all-out sprint.



Business is booming for Kevin Park with his Korean comfort food. He makes the deliveries, here to Elizabeth Delany of Framingham at a parking lot in Newton.

His business jumped from less than 10 orders a week in June to well over 100 since the start of July. He recently set up a website to funnel orders instead of spending hours sifting through his email. He hasn't even had time to calculate his profits yet.

"It's kind of crazy," Park said. "I'm just speechless."

Park's near-instant success is an anomaly, but he's one of hundreds across Massachusetts selling homemade food out of their kitchens on Facebook Marketplace, offering everything from Korean stews to pastries to seafood boils. It's not exactly a new phenomenon — Facebook Marketplace has been an entry point for home cooks trying to get a start for years —

FACEBOOK, Page A10

Past scandals are the focus of crowded DA field



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE 2023

Incumbent Michael W. Morrissey isn't running, and his would-be replacements aim to show they aren't like him.

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

Call it the Karen Read election, or the Michael Proctor campaign. Or, if you prefer, dub it the Michael W. Morrissey race since he's the name on everyone's lips.

None of those individuals are actually candidates for the Norfolk District Attorney's office, but you'd be forgiven for thinking otherwise, given how often the seven candidates in September's Democratic primary mention them.

This is, even by the idiosyncratic standards of local prosecutor races, a highly unusual election. A crowded field is vying to lead an office in a low-crime suburban county. Both candidates and voters are focused less on the nuances of

public safety policy and more on two astonishingly high-profile cases handled by Morrissey, the longtime incumbent who opted against seeking reelection amid intense scrutiny of his record.

Morrissey's would-be replacements are many: Jim Barakat, Greg Connor, Adam Deitch, Robert Jubinville, Macy Lee, Craig MacLellan, and Djuana Perkins are all seeking the Democratic nomination. There is also an independent candidate, Joe Pagliarulo, who will appear on the November general election ballot; there's no Republican in the race.

The candidates are hyping their leadership styles, each arguing they are the only one who can restore trust to an office groaning under the weight of

DISTRICT ATTORNEY, Page A7

The Red Sox, who have won 14 in a row, were rained out and will play a doubleheader today with a chance to set a new team record. **C1.**

Records show acrimonious litigation at Golden Temple, a Brookline restaurant that is closing after 66 years. **B5.**

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth faced questions over the war with Iran, which he estimated has cost \$37.5 billion so far. **A5.**

The head of the Smithsonian's National Museum of American History pushed back on the White House. **A2.**

A new wave of chefs and restaurateurs is ushering in a more sophisticated era on Cape Cod, long the world of lobster rolls and chowder. **G1.**



High joltage

Wednesday: Storms. High 83-88. Low 62-67.
Thursday: Sunny, less humid. High 75-80. Low 60-65.
High tide: 6:21 a.m., 6:41 p.m.
Sunrise: 5:27 Sunset: 8:14
Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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\$4.00

